Task 1B: Test Strategy Writing Framework

1 Introduction to the Test Strategy

Purpose of this section:
Show the examiner you understand what a test strategy is and why it's needed.

Prompts:

- What system or solution are you developing?
- Why does it need testing?
- What will the test strategy help you achieve?

Sentence starters:

- "The purpose of this test strategy is to ensure the system meets all functional and non-functional requirements…"
- "This strategy outlines the testing approach, order, and dependencies needed to ensure a high-quality final product…"

Tips:

✓ Keep this short (3–4 sentences)
✓ Mention quality, reliability, and meeting user/client needs

2 System Components & How They Interrelate

Purpose of this section:
Demonstrate decomposition + understanding of how parts connect (Band 3 requirement).

Prompts:

- What are the main components of your system?
- How does one component depend on another?
- What order do the components logically connect in?

Sentence starters:

- "The system is composed of several interrelated components including…"
- "These components depend on shared modules such as…"
- "Component X must be tested before Component Y because…"

Tips:

✓ Include 4–8 key components
✓ Show dependencies (e.g., login → access to features; inventory → orders)
✓ A simple list or short paragraph is enough

3 Test Approach (Types of Testing)

Purpose of this section:
Show you understand **black-box**, **white-box**, and **integration** testing.

Prompts:

- What will white-box testing check?
- What will black-box testing check?
- What needs integration testing?

Sentence starters:

- "Black-box testing will ensure that user-facing behaviour works as expected…"
- "White-box testing will validate internal logic such as calculations, branching, and input validation…"
- "Integration testing will be used to confirm that components work correctly together…"

Tips:

✓ You MUST mention all three testing types
✓ Give at least one example of what each will check

4 Order of Testing

Purpose of this section:
Demonstrate that you know what should be tested first and why.

Prompts:

- Which components must work before others?
- What tests come early?
- What tests happen later?
- What is the logical sequence?

Sentence starters:

- "Testing will begin with low-level components such as…"
- "Next, the mid-level features will be tested, including…"
- "Finally, system-wide and user-facing features will be tested…"

Tips:

✓ Start with shared logic
✓ Then individual components
✓ Then integrated workflows
✓ End with accessibility & regression

5 Traceability to Requirements

Purpose of this section:
Show that your tests link to system objectives and priorities.

Prompts:

- What requirements do your tests support?
- How does testing help satisfy the system goals?

Sentence starters:

- "Each test is linked to a requirement, such as users needing to…"
- "The test strategy ensures key requirements are met by checking…"

Tips:

✓ You can mention 2–4 requirements
✓ Do NOT list the whole requirement set
✓ Keep it brief but purposeful

6 Test Strategy Table (Main Evidence Section)

This is the part examiners grade most heavily.

Students must complete the four columns clearly:

Column 1: Date of Test

- Use a realistic timeline (over 2–4 days)
- Order should match your testing sequence

Column 2: Component to Be Tested

Prompts:

- What specific part of the system are you testing?
- Is it a low-level component (e.g., validation, database)?
- Or a high-level feature (e.g., ordering, profiles, dashboards)?

Tips:
✓ Use short, clear labels
✓ One component per row

Column 3: Type of Test to Be Carried Out

Prompts:

- Which type(s): black-box, white-box, integration?
- Why this combination?
- Does the order of test types matter?

Use sequences like:

- **White-box → Black-box → Integration**
- **Black-box → Integration**
- **Black-box only** (for accessibility)

Sentence starters:

- "White-box will test the internal logic such as…"
- "Black-box will confirm user-visible behaviour…"

- "Integration will check that Component X communicates with Component Y…"

Column 4: Prerequisites & Dependencies

Prompts:

- What must already be working before this test starts?
- What data, service, or function does this component rely on?
- What other component does it link to?

Sentence starters:

- "This test depends on…"
- "Before testing this component, the system must have…"
- "This feature relies on correct functioning of…"

Tips:
✓ Mention at least one dependency for each row
✓ Show understanding of component relationships

7 Stakeholder Involvement

Purpose of this section:
Show awareness that real systems involve real people.

Prompts:

- Which stakeholders should be involved?
- At what stage of testing?

Examples:

- End-users
- Clients
- Administrators
- Managers

Sentence starters:

- "Stakeholders will be involved in reviewing…"
- "User acceptance testing will allow key users to validate…"

8 Testing Throughout the Development Lifecycle

Purpose: Show you know testing isn't just at the end.

Prompts:

- What testing happens during design?
- What testing happens during development?
- When does integration testing occur?
- What happens after changes?

Sentence starters:

- "Testing will occur at all stages of development, beginning with…"
- "During integration, tests will focus on…"

9 Handling Late-Stage Changes (Regression Testing)

Purpose:
Show you understand how systems adapt when changed.

Prompts:

- What happens when a component is updated?
- How do you ensure nothing breaks?

Sentence starters:

- "If late-stage changes occur, targeted white-box testing will be used to inspect updated logic…"
- "This will be followed by integration and final black-box regression tests…"

10 Final Summary

Purpose:
Wrap up your strategy and emphasise quality.

Sentence starters:

- "This test strategy is comprehensive and ensures that all components are thoroughly tested…"

- “It demonstrates a full understanding of component relationships, testing order, and test types required…”

✨ Student Self-Check (Quick Band 3 Checklist)

✓ Does your test strategy show:

- Understanding of how components interrelate?
- Correct and logical order of testing?
- White-box, black-box, and integration testing?
- Dependencies for each component?
- Traceability to requirements?
- Lifecycle testing?
- Stakeholder involvement?
- Regression testing?

If YES → You are writing at **Band 3 level**.